MINI PROJECT | FINAL EVALUATION

Real-Time Network Intrusion Detection System

using Packet Inspection and Web-Based Alerting

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Problem Statement

Small networks have no real-time way to see attacks as they happen.

Where: homes, hostels and college labs

Today: attacks pass unseen in the packets

Gap: tools are manual, complex or unexplainable

Need: light, explainable, alerts within a second

ATTACKS DETECTED

Port Scan

tries every port to find an open one

SYN Flood

floods a server with half-open connections

ARP Spoofing

puts the attacker in the middle of traffic

Objectives: All Achieved

- ✓ Capture live TCP, UDP and ARP packets
- ✓ Detect port scans with a sliding-window rule
- ✓ Detect SYN floods from half-open handshakes
- ✓ Detect ARP spoofing from a trust table
- ✓ Alert pipeline to a Node.js and Express server
- ✓ Live web dashboard, updated without refresh
- ✓ Automated tests and measured performance

All seven objectives were met. All three attack rules are implemented, tested and shown live on the dashboard.

Existing Systems and the Gap

Existing tool	What it does well	Gap for small networks
Wireshark	Captures and decodes every packet	Manual study, no automatic alerts
Snort, Suricata	Professional rule-based detection	Complex rules, expert setup, log files
Zeek	Deep analysis with scripts	Steep learning curve, no live dashboard
ML-based IDS	High accuracy on test datasets	Black box, needs training data

MY SYSTEM FILLS THE GAP

Lightweight

about 200 lines, runs on a laptop

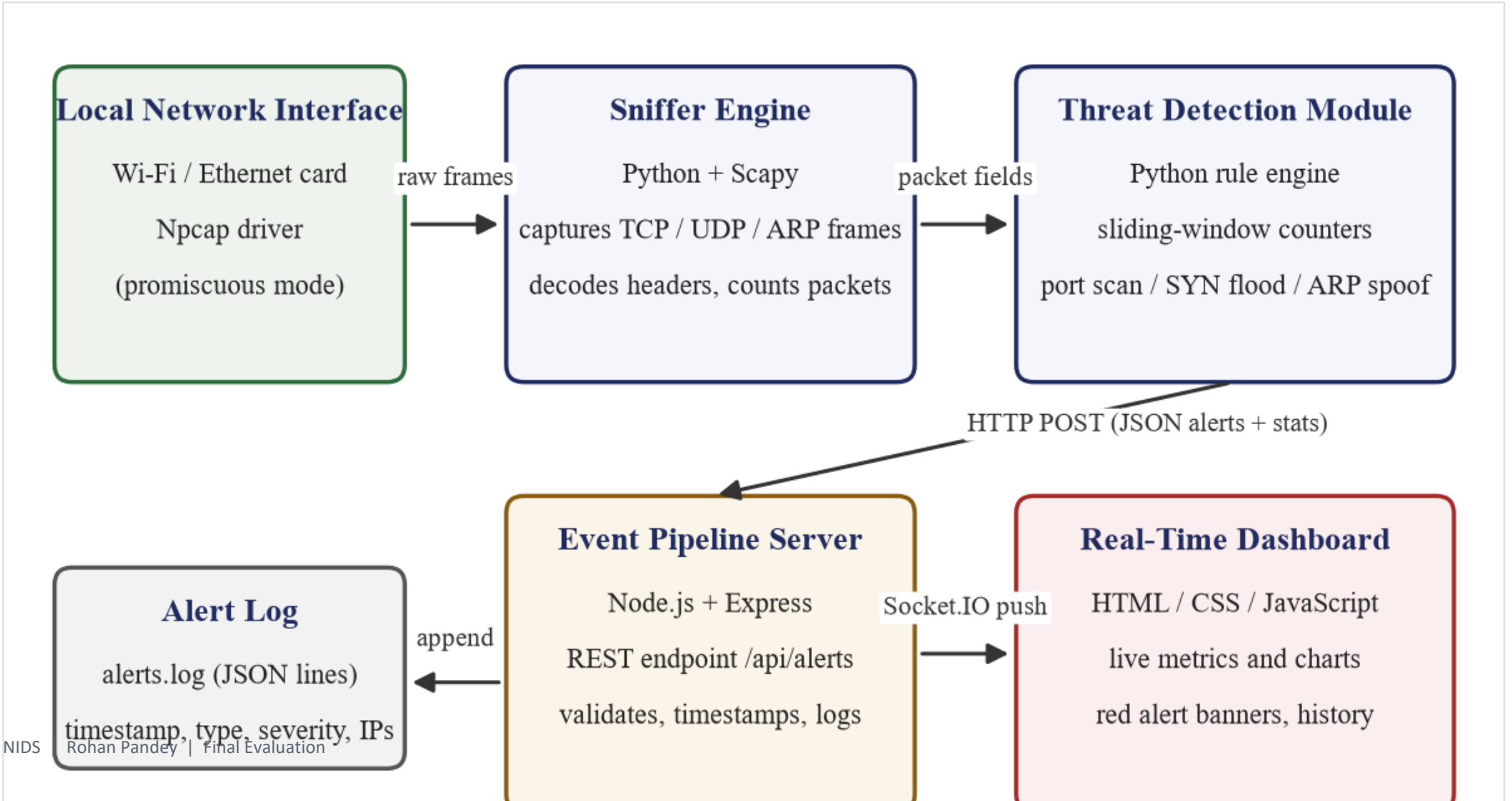
Explainable

every alert shows its threshold

Live

alert on the dashboard in under 1 second

System Architecture



Technology Stack

CAPTURE

Npcap 1.89

raw packets on Windows

SENSOR

Python 3.13 + Scapy 2.8

decodes IP, TCP, UDP, ARP

RULES

Python standard library

deque window, set of ports

SERVER

Node.js 24 + Express 5

receives alerts by HTTP POST

LIVE PUSH

Socket.IO 4

alerts reach the browser instantly

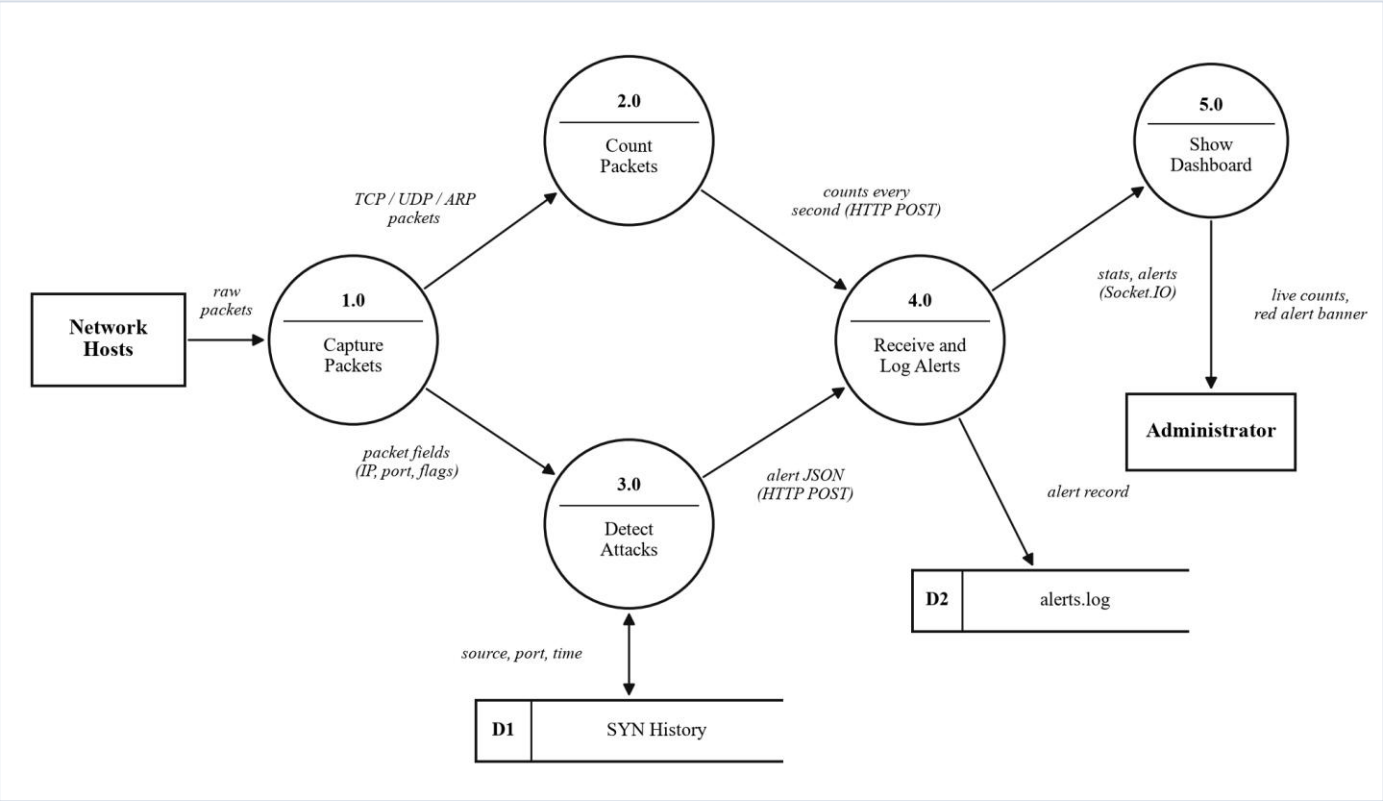
DASHBOARD

HTML, CSS, JS + Chart.js

live chart, table and banner

Storage: JSON alert log **Testing:** unittest, Nmap, Wireshark **Tools:** VS Code, Git, GitHub

System Design



Level-1 Data Flow Diagram

DESIGN ARTEFACTS

- Context and level-1 DFDs
- Use-case diagram
- Sequence diagram
- Component diagram
- Deployment diagram
- Flowchart of the port-scan rule

All diagrams are in the report, **numbered chapter-wise** as Fig. 3.1 to 4.2.

Detection Rules

Port Scan

> 15 distinct ports

from one source

within 5 seconds

medium

SYN Flood

100+ half-open SYNs

to one host

few completed

high

ARP Spoofing

gateway IP seen

with a different

MAC address

critical

All rules are deterministic. Each keeps a few seconds of history in a sliding window, compares a count against a threshold, and raises an alert with a cool-down so one attack gives one alert.

Testing

UNIT TESTS

10 / 10

tests passing
one per rule, with
positive and negative cases

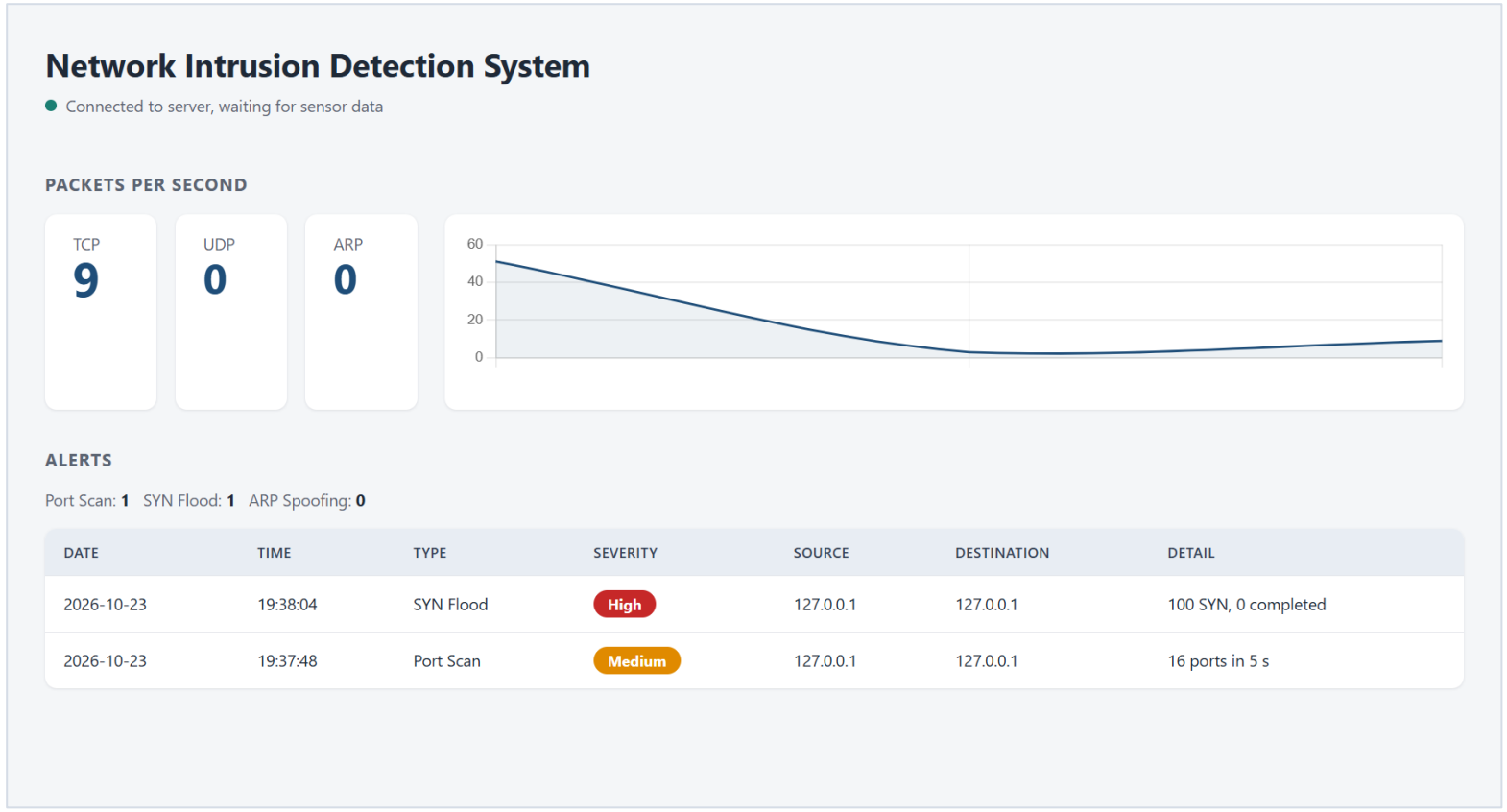
INTEGRATION TESTS

Real port scan and SYN flood against the host
Alert reached the dashboard and log in a few ms
No false alarm during normal browsing

What the negative tests confirm

- Reply (SYN-ACK) packets are not a scan
- Completed handshakes are not a flood
- Genuine ARP replies raise no alarm
- Slow activity below the threshold stays silent
- A port scan is not mistaken for a flood
- A cool-down stops duplicate alerts

Results: Live Dashboard



Dashboard after detecting a port scan and a SYN flood

3 attacks detected

~2 ms detection latency

10/10 unit tests pass

~200 lines of code

Conclusion and Future Scope

A complete, working NIDS. All objectives met: live capture, three transparent detection rules, an alert pipeline, and a real-time dashboard, verified by ten unit tests and live attacks, in about 200 lines of code.

KEY STRENGTHS

- ✓ Every alert traceable to a threshold
- ✓ Real-time: under one second
- ✓ Small, readable, easy to extend
- ✓ Fails safely if the server is down

FUTURE SCOPE

- More rules: ICMP flood, DNS tunnelling
- E-mail or messaging notifications
- Store alerts in SQLite, searchable
- Authenticate the sensor to the server
- Active response: firewall the attacker

Thank You

Questions are welcome

github.com/rohanpandey436/realtime-nids

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